1. Startup Landscape Analysis

Before diving into specific analyses, your first task is to understand the overall startup landscape in our database. The executive team needs a snapshot of how many companies have failed (closed down) versus how many are still operating or have been acquired. This will help establish the baseline success rate in the startup ecosystem.

Calculate the number of companies that have been closed down.

```sql
SELECT
    COUNT(*)
FROM
    company
WHERE
    status= 'closed'
```

Result

count
2584

2. Sector Analysis for US Investors

One of our major clients, a US-based VC firm, is considering investments in the media and news space. They've asked us to provide data on how much funding news-related companies from the USA have raised historically, to help them benchmark appropriate investment amounts.

Print the amount of money news-related companies from the USA have raised. Use data from the `company` table. Sort the resulting table by the `funding_total` field in descending order to see the most well-funded companies first.

```sql
SELECT
    funding_total
FROM
    company
WHERE
    category_code= 'news'
    AND country_code= 'USA'
ORDER BY
    funding_total DESC;
```

Result

funding_total
6.22553e+08
2.5e+08
1.605e+08
1.28e+08

3. Analyzing Cash Acquisitions

Our quarterly report includes a section on acquisition trends. The team needs to understand the volume of cash-based acquisitions (as opposed to stock deals) that occurred during the recent post-recession period (2011-2013). This data will help identify whether companies were primarily acquired with cash or other payment methods during this economic recovery period.

Find the total amount of company acquisitions in US dollars. Select only the deals made in cash from 2011 to 2013, inclusive.

```sql
SELECT
    SUM(price_amount)
FROM
    acquisition
WHERE
    term_code= 'cash'
    AND (acquired_at >= '2011-01-01' AND acquired_at <= '2013-12-31');
```

Result

sum
1.37762e+11